

guidance to people and provides direction details down to specific house numbers. The augmented reality with 3D landmarks also gives it an edge over other navigational devices in the market. Users can even find the exact location of their friends in the contact list with the friend finder option. Along with the CarPad comes the car-kit, which includes head-rest and windshield mounts to fix the tablet in the rear or front seats. The CarPad offers 3G connectivity with a 2MP camera, and has a SIM card slot that enables the tablet to be used as a phone to make calls and send messages.

The tablet is priced at around Rs 22,000, which includes the cost of the car kit (Rs 6,990).

European parliaments to use open source XML tools to write laws

Several parliaments in the European Union are currently mulling over using open source XML tools to produce legal texts and documents. Bungeni and Akoma Ntoso from Africa, and xmLeges and NIR from Italy are presently being considered to write legal texts. Open source XML editor Bungeni was presented at the UK parliament in March this year, while the European Parliament's IT department last year validated the Akoma Ntoso XML Framework as fit for use by the European Parliament.

Vodafone to launch Webbox, Android phone

Vodafone will launch a QWERTY keyboard this month that helps use the television as a computer. The Android 2.1-based Webbox uses A/V input cables to connect to the TV and turns the TV into an Internet portal. It comes with 140 MB of memory, which is expandable up to 16 GB. It gives access to Android apps but works on a 2G network and supports Edge. The Webbox will cost Rs 5,799. The service provider has offered 2GB data free for six months.

Vodafone will also launch a smartphone named Smart. The Android 2.2 phone has a 528 MHz Qualcomm processor, an Adreno 200 GPU and a 7.1 cm (2.8 inch) touchscreen display. The full touchscreen phone has 150 MB of internal memory, which is expandable up to 32 GB. The phone will have a 2MP camera and is 3G enabled. It is expected to have up to 250 hours of operation on a 2G network and up to 380 hours on 3G networks. Besides numerous Android apps, the phone will be pre-loaded with Vodafone Find and Go, Vodafone Music and a GPS navigator app. The phone is likely to be priced between Rs 6,000 and Rs 7,000.

Samsung pulls Galaxy Tab 7.7 from IFA

Samsung Electronics has pulled its new Android tablet from both the IFA show floor and its German website, after Apple won an injunction blocking German sales of the recently launched Galaxy Tab 7.7. The move is in compliance with the decision handed down by the Düsseldorf Regional Court (the same court that had banned sales of the Galaxy Tab 10.1 last month).



iNecklace: An open source accessory from Adafruit

Adafruit Industries has released an exquisite open source accessory, the iNecklace, which is an electronic pendant with a battery and pulsating LED that would gently pulsate for up to 72 hours.



Made up of the finest 6-series aluminium for durability, the open source based iNecklace can be reprogrammed to any pattern; and its source code, circuit board files, schematics and CAD files are posted on Github, Mod and Hack Away!

Sony launches Android-based Walkman

Sony unveiled its latest entry in the music player market at the IFA 2011, Berlin. It showed a prototype of a new Walkman that is based on Google's Android operating system. The Walkman is expected to stand in competition against Apple's iPod Touch. The Walkman Mobile Entertainment Player has a lot of music features, including special controls.



Twitter brings out an open source toolkit for app developers

Twitter has rolled out Bootstrap, an online open source toolkit for app developers. Bootstrap will help developers build new apps. Twitter has released these tools on the popular code-sharing site GitHub.

